GRADE 8 · TERM 1 · LESSON 16

PERSONAL INITIATIVE

Lesson icons

LEARNING OUTCOMES

🔍 💡 By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- Define personal initiative.
- Identify a problem you could solve without being asked.
- Take the first small step toward action.

📘 KEY VOCABULARY

Term	Definition	isiZulu	Afrikaans
Initiative	Acting without being told	Isinyathelo sokuqala	Inisiatief
Notice	To become aware of something	Ukuqaphela	Opmerk
Act	To do something	Ukwenza	Optree

📘 MYAH AT THE TAXI RANK

Myah is sitting at the taxi rank, waiting for a taxi home. It is hot. The sun is high. People are fanning themselves with newspapers. A baby is crying. A woman is wiping sweat from her forehead.

Myah notices.

She does not know the word "initiative." She does not know she is learning something. She just sees.

She watches the people. The heat. The waiting. The frustration. She writes in her notebook: What would help here? What would make this better?

She does not have answers. She is just asking questions. But the questions themselves are a kind of action. They are the beginning of something.

She files it away. Years later, when she learns about problems and opportunities, she will remember this day. The hot taxi rank. The thirsty people. The baby crying.

The noticing was the first step.

⬜ THINKING EQUATION

Initiative = Notice + Act

No Permission Required

📘 WHAT IS PERSONAL INITIATIVE?

Personal initiative is acting without being told.

It is:

- Seeing what needs to be done
- Doing it without waiting for permission
- Starting before you feel ready

People with initiative:

- Notice problems others ignore
- Try solutions even if they might fail
- Learn by doing

You do not need to be grown to have initiative. You just need to notice. And then act — even a small act.

💭 REFLECT

Pause and Reflect

Think of a problem you have noticed. What is it? What could you do — even a small thing — to help?

—

✍️ ACTIVITY

Activity 21: My First Step — With Deadline Commitment

Part A: The Problem

Identify one small problem you could help solve this week.

Problem: —

Who does it affect? —

One small thing I could do: —

Part B: The Deadline

When EXACTLY will you take your first step? Not "this week" — name the day and time. Write it as a promise to yourself.

—

I will take my first step on — at — .

The first step is: —

How I will know I did it (evidence): —

Portfolio evidence

Deepening Insight

TAP TO EXPLORE THE DEEPER IDEA

Initiative is not about being brave. It is about being attentive. Most people see a problem and think, "Someone should do something." A few people see a problem and think, "I could do something." The difference is not courage. It is attention. Attention to the need. Attention to your own capacity. Attention to

the small step you can take right now. You do not need to solve the whole problem. You just need to take the first step. The second step will reveal itself after you take the first one.

1. What is one problem you have been waiting for someone else to solve?

SYNTHETIC_INITIATIVE_PROBLEM

---

2. What would happen if you took one small step toward it this week?

SYNTHETIC_INITIATIVE_STEP

✅ CHECKPOINT

Checkpoint (🛠️ Apply)

1. What did Myah notice at the taxi rank?

_

2. Did she solve the problem that day?

_

3. Why not?

_

4. What was the first step she took — even without acting?

_

What is the biggest REASON you might not take your first step? (Fear? Forgetting? No resources? No permission?) Now write: When that reason appears, I will _____.

5. The reason I might not act:

_

6. When that reason appears, I will:

_

🏠 TRY THIS AT HOME

Behavioral Experiment

Take your first step. Do it. Then record:

Did I take my first step? —

What happened? —

What was harder than I expected? —

What was easier? —

1. If I did not take my first step: What stopped me?

—

2. Was it a real obstacle or an excuse in disguise?

—

3. How do I know the difference?

Write honestly.

—

Lesson Wrap

What we learned

- Personal initiative combines noticing a need with taking action.
- A first step can be small and have a clear deadline.

Why it matters

You can begin addressing a problem without pretending you can solve all of it at once.

Coming next

ACCURATE THINKING

LESSON NOTES

Anything you want to remember

Your responses are captured beside each activity, reflection, table and workbook field. Use this separate space only for extra notes you want to keep about the lesson.